

ORIGINAL



9/26/08

Secretary
The Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol St. N.W.
Washington DC 20573

Dear Sir,

As a NVOCC we purchase space aboard ocean vessels and then sell that space to shippers, in a highly competitive marketplace. The ability to compete and operate efficiently is undermined by regulations that require for us to publish our negotiated rates in formal tariffs as required with the current FMC filings. This is out of step with a modern ocean transportation environment. To file information about an agreement after-the-fact only adds to enormous expense and inefficiency. It also provides little value to the shipping public, as customers seldom review the tariff.

The National Customs Brokers & Forwards Association of America, Inc. (NCBFAA) has filed a petition to exempt ocean transport intermediaries from this onerous requirement, an exemption that has already been provided to ocean carriers.

I would appreciate your taking note of our position and support of this exemption by incorporating this letter in the record.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads 'Laurie Arnold'.

Laurie Arnold
Corporate License Broker/CCS
JAS Forwarding (USA) Inc

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